BABYSTEPS · PROJECT DOCUMENT

Project charter

The agreement on what BabySteps is for, who is involved, how long each phase takes and how the project is judged.

PROJECT
BabySteps

PREPARED BY
Aditi Kela, product lead

VERSION
1.0, draft for review

DATE
October 15, 2026

CONFIRMED from the built app or from you ESTIMATE my working figure
PROPOSED a plan or target to test SOURCED from a cited public page TO CONFIRM needs your input

PROJECT
BabySteps, an AI parenting companion for first-time parents CONFIRMED

PROJECT OWNER
Aditi Kela, product lead and designer CONFIRMED

FUNDING
Self-funded personal project CONFIRMED

PLATFORM
Web app hosted on Base44 CONFIRMED

BUILD METHOD
Spec for each feature, built by directing Claude Code, reviewed against the Figma designs CONFIRMED

IN-APP AI
Guidance generated with the Claude API CONFIRMED

Purpose

New parents collect advice from many places, and much of it ignores where they live. Food guidance, vaccine schedules, growth standards and financial advice change by country, yet most baby apps give one answer to everyone. BabySteps puts tracking and memory-keeping in one app and uses the parent's country to set units, the vaccine schedule and regional guidance. CONFIRMED

Objectives

#	OBJECTIVE	MEASURE OF SUCCESS	TARGET	BASIS
1	Ship a working app covering the daily log, health and growth, age-aware guides and a memory vault	Feature areas live in the app	4 of 4	CONFIRMED Met

#	OBJECTIVE	MEASURE OF SUCCESS	TARGET	BASIS
2	Make guidance country-aware	Countries with their own units, vaccine schedule and guidance	2 live (US and India)	CONFIRMED Met
3	Learn from real parents before adding more features	Completed interviews or survey responses	8 to 10 interviews, 30 survey responses	PROPOSED
4	Add an AI chatbot for questions the guides do not answer	Chatbot released; answers rated helpful in testing	At least 80% rated helpful in the first test round	PROPOSED target
5	Add a shared time capsule so family can contribute letters	Shared capsule released; invited contributors who add an entry	At least 1 contributor in 50% of shared capsules	PROPOSED target
6	Keep running cost low while the user base is small	Monthly cost at 100 active families	Under $100 a month	ESTIMATE see budget

Deliverables

- Figma flows and screens for every feature CONFIRMED
- Written spec for each feature, used to direct the build CONFIRMED
- Working web app with country-aware settings, daily log, growth charts, guides and memory vault CONFIRMED
- A 45-second walkthrough video and app screenshots for the portfolio CONFIRMED
- Next release: chatbot and shared time capsule CONFIRMED in progress
- Research findings report after the interview round PROPOSED

Stakeholders and roles

WHO	ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY	BASIS
Aditi Kela	Product lead and designer	Chooses the problem, the flows and what ships. Writes the spec. Reviews all output against the designs.	CONFIRMED
Claude Code	Build assistant	Writes the code from each feature spec.	CONFIRMED
Claude API	In-app guidance	Generates the age and country guidance shown in the app.	CONFIRMED
First-time parents	Target users	Supply the problems, the language and the test feedback.	CONFIRMED audience, PROPOSED participation
Northeastern Expo 2026 visitors	Early audience	Saw the app when it was presented.	CONFIRMED

Timeline

Durations are project weeks, not calendar dates. The completed phases show what the project involved. Their lengths are my reconstruction and need your correction. TO CONFIRM

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	DURATION	STATUS	BASIS
1. Frame the problem	Define the parent, the pain and the one big idea (country-aware guidance)	1 week	Complete	ESTIMATE
2. Design in Figma	Flows and screens for home, log, learn, profile and memory	2 weeks	Complete	ESTIMATE
3. Spec and build	One written spec per feature, built with Claude Code	4 weeks	Complete	ESTIMATE
4. Review and fix	Compare the build with the Figma designs and correct the gaps	1 week	Complete	ESTIMATE
5. Show it	Northeastern Expo 2026	1 event	Complete	CONFIRMED
6. Parent research	8 to 10 interviews, a 30-response survey, synthesis	3 weeks	Next	PROPOSED
7. Chatbot	Design, build and test the AI chatbot	3 weeks	In progress	CONFIRMED started, ESTIMATE length
8. Shared time capsule	Invite family, collect entries, lock until a date	3 weeks	In progress	CONFIRMED started, ESTIMATE length
9. Closed beta	20 to 30 families use the app for 4 weeks and give feedback	5 weeks	Planned	PROPOSED

Rough total for phases 1 to 5: about 9 weeks of effort. Phases 6 to 9 add about 14 weeks if run one after another, or about 9 if research runs alongside the chatbot.

ESTIMATE

Milestones and decision gates

GATE	QUESTION TO ANSWER	EVIDENCE REQUIRED
G1: Design sign-off	Do the Figma flows cover every feature in scope?	All screens reviewed against the scope document
G2: Build sign-off	Does each feature match its spec and design?	Spec checklist passed, side-by-side with Figma
G3: Research gate	Do parents want the chatbot and shared capsule as planned?	Interview themes and survey results support or change the scope
G4: Beta gate	Is the app safe and accurate enough for outside families?	Accuracy review of vaccine schedules and guidance, privacy checklist done

Risks

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Health guidance or vaccine schedules are wrong or out of date	Medium	High	Source each schedule from the national body (for India, the IAP; for the US, the CDC), show the source in the app and review before each release

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
AI guidance reads as medical advice	Medium	High	Label guidance as information, add a "talk to your pediatrician" line, limit the chatbot to non-diagnostic topics
Baby and family data is sensitive	Medium	High	Collect the minimum, explain what is stored, support deletion, review hosting settings before beta
Sign-in blocks people from seeing the app	High	Medium	Offer a demo account and a walkthrough video
AI usage cost grows faster than users	Low	Medium	Use the smaller model for routine guidance and set a monthly cost cap
Solo builder time	High	Medium	Keep each phase to three weeks or less and cut scope before moving a date

Assumptions and constraints

- One person leads design, product and review. The AI writes the code. CONFIRMED
- Tooling stays on free or low-cost plans. PROPOSED
- The app is a web app. A native app is outside this charter. CONFIRMED
- Any claim about parents' needs stays a hypothesis until the research phase finishes. PROPOSED

Approval

NAME	ROLE	VERSION	DATE
Aditi Kela	Project owner and product lead	1.0, draft for review	October 15, 2026